

Qualification Pack



Genetic Counselor

QP Code: HSS/Q8705

Version: 3.0

NSQF Level: 6.5

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HSS/Q8705: Genetic Counselor

Brief Job Description

The individual is responsible for obtaining clinical, family and health information, advising individuals/families about their risk of inheriting genetic diseases, informing testing options for diagnosis and providing available options to prevent/ treat genetic conditions. They also focus on empowering their patients by helping them understand and adjust to the genetic conditions. Individuals would keep oneself abreast of the latest technologies and future opportunities of broadening the scope of work in context of recent advancements in human genomics and genetic counselling. They should be able to apply genomics in different medical specialties, personalized/precision medicine and disease research.

Personal Attributes

The job requires individuals to be proficient in communication skills. They must possess sensitivity towards the emotional wellbeing of patients.

Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)

Compulsory NOS:

1. [HSS/N8713: Collect detailed patient and family history to draw a pedigree](#)
2. [HSS/N8714: Assess risk for genetic disorders or syndromes](#)
3. [HSS/N8715: Provide counselling on various genetic tests and coordinate for their execution](#)
4. [HSS/N8716: Interpret the inferences of the genetic tests and carry out post- test counselling](#)
5. [HSS/N8717: Provide need- based genetic counselling to the patient and their family members](#)
6. [HSS/N8718: Promote genetics related awareness](#)
7. [HSS/N9620: Comply with infection control and biomedical waste disposal policies](#)
8. [DGT/VSQ/N0103: Employability Skills \(90 Hours\)](#)

Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters

Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Social Work & Community Health
Occupation	Counselling

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Country	India
NSQF Level	6.5
Credits	40
Aligned to NCO/ISCO/ISIC Code	NCO/2015/2635
Minimum Educational Qualification & Experience	Completed 4 year UG degree with Honours/ Honours with research ((Medical Graduate (MBBS/ BHMS/ BAMS/ BUMS)/Graduate (Nursing/ Allied Health Professionals)/BDS/life sciences/clinical psychology/ biotechnology/ pharmacy/ B. Tech Biotechnology or genetics) with NA of experience
Minimum Level of Education for Training in School	
Pre-Requisite License or Training	Not Applicable
Minimum Job Entry Age	21 Years
Last Reviewed On	NA
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Approval Date	08/05/2025
Version	3.0
Reference code on NQR	QG-6.5-HE-04217-2025-V2-HSSC
NQR Version	2

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HSS/N8713: Collect detailed patient and family history to draw a pedigree

Description

This unit covers the knowledge and skills required to obtain a family history and draw pedigree charts

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Obtain and record a comprehensive clinical and family history of the patient
- Prepare a pedigree chart to assess inheritance patterns

Elements and Performance Criteria

Obtain and record a comprehensive clinical and family history of the patient

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** obtain written consent from the patient
- PC2.** extract the detailed history of a patient, including family history or any other genetic disorders in the family to assess the chance of disease occurrence or recurrence
- PC3.** communicate in a culture, religious and gender sensitive manner while obtaining a family history
- PC4.** record the clinical findings using appropriate terminology
- PC5.** record the relevant details from medical documents of the patient
- PC6.** document the physical examination findings of the patients/relatives including detailed anthropometry
- PC7.** elicit developmental history in detail
- PC8.** elicit and document the reproductive and perinatal history
- PC9.** maintain the confidentiality of medical information of the patients and families

Prepare a pedigree chart to assess inheritance patterns

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** • ask questions about the medical and clinical history of the patient and family members such as siblings, parents, aunts, uncles, cousins, nieces, nephews and grandparents, etc.
- PC11.** • draw a basic outline of the family tree using pedigree symbols, standard notation, and nomenclature with proficiency and accuracy
- PC12.** • record the gathered information on the pedigree chart drawn to complete the pedigree analysis
- PC13.** • assess the probability of conditions with a genetic component or carrier status using relevant knowledge and data based on pedigree analysis
- PC14.** • apprise the patient/ family members sensitively of the cause, inheritance, risk of a genetic anomaly and its likelihood of affecting other family members.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

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- KU1.** relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures in the field of genetics followed in the healthcare organization/country.
- KU2.** SOPs of maintaining patient's genetics file
- KU3.** current professional hierarchy of genetic counselors, at the institutional, state, regional and national levels.
- KU4.** service request procedures, tools, and techniques
- KU5.** role and responsibilities of a genetic counselor and other members of the multi-disciplinary team
- KU6.** importance of attributes such as empathy, patience, tolerance, integrity, ethics etc
- KU7.** importance of respecting religious and cultural diversity
- KU8.** foundations of genetics, embryology, dysmorphology, principles of genetics, medical genetics
- KU9.** foundations of pedigree chart/tree symbols
- KU10.** family history and pedigree analysis
- KU11.** anatomy and physiology of human beings
- KU12.** basic Mendelian genetics and deviations
- KU13.** fundamentals of cell biology, molecules, embryology, cells, genomics and chromosome studies
- KU14.** basics and the importance of inheritance patterns of genetic disorders and penetrance estimates
- KU15.** basics of taking patient history, making observations and the process of their interpretation to arrive at differential diagnosis and further testing to confirm a diagnosis
- KU16.** the nature of the diagnosis, common clinical presentation, information about the previous investigation, anticipated course of the disease, complications, risk estimation and management of common genetic diseases
- KU17.** standard questions to obtain family and clinical history
- KU18.** importance of displaying empathy towards PwD.
- KU19.** different type of disabilities, genetic syndromes and disorders such as congenital anomalies, anatomic deformities etc
- KU20.** principles of medical and public health genetics and genomics
- KU21.** genetic principles and how they contribute to etiology, clinical features, and disease expression, natural history, differential diagnosis, genetic testing and test report interpretation, pathophysiology, recurrence risk, management and prevention, and population screening
- KU22.** difference between patterns of inheritance
- KU23.** importance of maintaining privacy
- KU24.** the verbal and non-verbal cues of the patient and relatives

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** document call logs, reports, task lists, and schedules
- GS2.** write history, clinical findings, status and progress reports without making language errors

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- GS3.** plan for secure record keeping
- GS4.** write memos and e-mail to patient and the family, co-workers, and vendors
- GS5.** record the proceedings of counselling session to share with patients, family members, and other healthcare professionals
- GS6.** be updated on the recent advances in the field of genetics in India and other countries by reading relevant published literature, brochures, pamphlets, product information sheets and through participation in professional conferences and seminars
- GS7.** network with clinical, diagnostic and research specialists
- GS8.** communicate relevant and latest genetic and genomic information to help patients and families understand and adapt to conditions or the risk of conditions
- GS9.** communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious, gender and PwD sensitivity
- GS10.** use a range of tools to enhance the learning encounter such as handouts, visual aids, and other educational technologies
- GS11.** give clear instructions to the patients/relatives and keep them informed about progress
- GS12.** speak and write in a clear manner and avoid using jargon, slang or acronyms when communicating with a patient, unless it is required
- GS13.** build a therapeutic rapport and manage relationships with patient and the family who may be stressed, frustrated, confused, grieving in denial or angry
- GS14.** build interpersonal relationships that foster inter- and intra-departmental unity and coordination
- GS15.** apply, analyze, and evaluate the information gathered from observation, experience, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to thought and action

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Obtain and record a comprehensive clinical and family history of the patient</i>	23	10	10	20
PC1. obtain written consent from the patient	-	-	-	-
PC2. extract the detailed history of a patient, including family history or any other genetic disorders in the family to assess the chance of disease occurrence or recurrence	-	-	-	-
PC3. communicate in a culture, religious and gender sensitive manner while obtaining a family history	-	-	-	-
PC4. record the clinical findings using appropriate terminology	-	-	-	-
PC5. record the relevant details from medical documents of the patient	-	-	-	-
PC6. document the physical examination findings of the patients/relatives including detailed anthropometry	-	-	-	-
PC7. elicit developmental history in detail	-	-	-	-
PC8. elicit and document the reproductive and perinatal history	-	-	-	-
PC9. maintain the confidentiality of medical information of the patients and families	-	-	-	-
<i>Prepare a pedigree chart to assess inheritance patterns</i>	23	10	10	20
PC10. • ask questions about the medical and clinical history of the patient and family members such • as siblings, parents, aunts, uncles, cousins, nieces, nephews and grandparents, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC11. • draw a basic outline of the family tree using pedigree symbols, standard notation, and • nomenclature with proficiency and accuracy	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC12. - record the gathered information on the pedigree chart drawn to complete the pedigree - analysis	-	-	-	-
PC13. - assess the probability of conditions with a genetic component or carrier status using relevant - knowledge and data based on pedigree analysis	-	-	-	-
PC14. - apprise the patient/ family members sensitively of the cause, inheritance, risk of a genetic - anomaly and its likelihood of affecting other family members.	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	46	20	20	40

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N8713
NOS Name	Collect detailed patient and family history to draw a pedigree
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Social Work & Community Health
Occupation	Counselling
NSQF Level	6.5
Credits	7
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

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HSS/N8714: Assess risk for genetic disorders or syndromes

Description

This unit covers how to assess probability/ risks for specific genetic disorders or syndromes based on initial findings and counsel the patient/ family members on related parameters such as nature, type and prognosis of the genetic disease.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Assess the probability/ risk of a genetic condition or carrier status
- Identify suitable genetic/predictive tests
- Carry out pre-test counselling by interpreting preliminary test results

Elements and Performance Criteria

Assess the probability/ risk of a genetic condition or carrier status

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** carry out a risk assessment using previously captured information, data based on pedigree analysis, inheritance patterns, genetic epidemiology, genetics principles, quantitative/ mathematical calculations
- PC2.** educate the patient and family members on etiopathogenesis, common clinical presentations, anticipated course of disease, complications, and management of genetic disorders
- PC3.** identify broad disease groups where the diagnosis is not apparent
- PC4.** assess psychological problems or needs of the patients of families like fear, stress, stigma, marital conflicts, etc.
- PC5.** provide information about the prognosis based on preliminary findings

Identify suitable genetic/genomic tests

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** identify various genetic testing options such as screening, diagnostic and genomic genetic tests
- PC7.** prepare a list of screening, diagnostic and predictive genetic tests required to be performed for a patient/family based on history, clinical findings and course of the disease
- PC8.** evaluate various genetic testing options such as screening, diagnostic and genomic genetic tests as per patient's feasibility

Carry out pre-test counselling while interpreting preliminary test results

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC9.** maintain the confidentiality of medical information regarding patients and families
- PC10.** prepare a plan of action based on preliminary findings
- PC11.** educate the patient about various genetic testing options such as screening, diagnostic and genomic genetic tests

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- PC12.** apprise the patients and their family members of important aspects of all types of screening and diagnostic genetic testing options such as the availability, analytic and clinical validity etc.
- PC13.** interpret the clinical implications of preliminary genetic test reports
- PC14.** conduct an empirical risk assessment by applying the results of the preliminary tests
- PC15.** apprise the patient of the importance and procedure to carry out predictive genetic testing
- PC16.** interpret the results of pre-symptomatic genetic testing/ carrier testing
- PC17.** guide the patient/ family about various aspects of the test results such as the nature, type, and prognosis of genetic diseases
- PC18.** advise the patient about the differential diagnosis of common presentations in genetic disorders
- PC19.** convey to patient and family, the possibility of likely genetic disorder and plan of required investigations for reaching a diagnosis
- PC20.** address the concerns of the family/patient, allay the doubts based on the available factual information
- PC21.** inform about different types, benefits, and applicable limitations of prenatal and pre-implantation genetic screening tests.
- PC22.** inform about various procedures performed for prenatal sample collection e.g. amniocentesis, chorionic villus biopsy, umbilical cord blood sampling
- PC23.** inform the patient and the family members about the success rates and failure of each procedure
- PC24.** advise the patient/ family members to share the results of genetic tests with at- risk family members
- PC25.** carry out the process of providing information about the risks of chromosomes abnormalities, birth defects

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures in the field of genetics followed in the healthcare organization/ country.
- KU2.** read relevant information about the genetic disease or the mutations
- KU3.** internal and external specialists to be contacted for support to resolve incidents and service requests
- KU4.** service request procedures, tools, and techniques
- KU5.** foundations of genetic counseling and medical genetics
- KU6.** significance of empathy and compassion
- KU7.** difference between chromosomal versus genetic (Mendelian) disorders and relevant diagnostic tests
- KU8.** concept and prevalence of consanguinity, endogamy, founder mutations
- KU9.** uncertainties in the tests due to various causes like undetected/unidentified causative mutation

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- KU10.** the availability, analytic validity, clinical validity, and clinical utility of all types of genetic testing
- KU11.** the verbal and non-verbal cues of the patient and relatives
- KU12.** the difference between the screening and diagnostic procedures such as ultrasound, NIPT maternal blood sampling, biochemical test vs Chorionic Villus Sampling (CVS) and amniocentesis.
- KU13.** basics of making observations and the process of their interpretation to arrive at differential diagnosis and further testing to confirm a diagnosis
- KU14.** specific considerations relevant to genetic versus genomic and clinical versus research testing
- KU15.** differential diagnosis of common presentations in genetic disorders
- KU16.** aspects of screening and diagnostic genetic testing options such as the availability, analytic and clinical validity, clinical utility, potential benefits, risks, limitations, and costs etc
- KU17.** the importance of carrying out pre- symptomatic genetic testing
- KU18.** process and importance of conveying important information to other team members involved in the care of patients
- KU19.** the SOPs of carrying out pre- implantation studies
- KU20.** the SOPs of carrying out newborn screening
- KU21.** accuracy and reliability of various diagnostic tests
- KU22.** the importance of non-directive, non-paternalistic and non-judgmental approach when counseling the patients and relatives
- KU23.** the concept of non-maleficence
- KU24.** types of genetic disorders Chromosomal disorders, Monogenic (Mendelian) inheritance, Polygenic or multifactorial, and Mitochondrial disorders
- KU25.** principles of prenatal diagnosis, different modalities available for prenatal diagnosis
- KU26.** basic principles and methodologies of common genetic test procedures
- KU27.** available diagnostic tests for prenatal and postnatal diagnosis
- KU28.** demarcation of teratogenic versus genetic causes of disease conditions
- KU29.** principles of prenatal diagnosis, different modalities available for prenatal diagnosis

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** document call logs, reports, task lists, and schedules
- GS2.** write history, clinical findings, status and progress reports
- GS3.** plan for secure record keeping
- GS4.** be updated on the recent advances in the field of genetics in India and other countries by reading relevant published literature, brochures, pamphlets, product information sheets and through participation in professional conferences and seminars
- GS5.** read comments, suggestions, and responses to Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) posted on the helpdesk portal
- GS6.** deliberate task lists, schedules, and work-loads with co-workers

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- GS7.** communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious and gender sensitivity
- GS8.** give clear instructions to the patients/relatives and keep them informed about progress
- GS9.** speak and write in a clear manner and avoid using jargon, slang or acronyms when communicating with a patient, unless it is required
- GS10.** make decisions about the concerned area of work
- GS11.** interact adequately with personnel in other departments to coordinate for the investigations and care plan
- GS12.** plan and organize sessions of counseling
- GS13.** maintain ethical behaviour while dealing with the patients and families
- GS14.** network between advocacy groups/support groups and clinicians, researchers
- GS15.** build a therapeutic rapport and manage relationships with patient and the family who may be stressed, frustrated, confused, grieving in denial or angry
- GS16.** maintain cordial relationships with all other team members
- GS17.** think through the problem, evaluate the possible solution(s) and suggest an optimum /best possible solution(s)
- GS18.** apply, analyze, and evaluate the information gathered from observation, experience, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to thought and action

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Assess the probability/ risk of a genetic condition or carrier status</i>	32	20	10	25
PC1. carry out a risk assessment using previously captured information, data based on pedigree analysis, inheritance patterns, genetic epidemiology, genetics principles, quantitative/ mathematical calculations	-	-	-	-
PC2. educate the patient and family members on etiopathogenesis, common clinical presentations, anticipated course of disease, complications, and management of genetic disorders	-	-	-	-
PC3. identify broad disease groups where the diagnosis is not apparent	-	-	-	-
PC4. assess psychological problems or needs of the patients of families like fear, stress, stigma, marital conflicts, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC5. provide information about the prognosis based on preliminary findings	-	-	-	-
<i>Identify suitable genetic/genomic tests</i>	30	20	10	25
PC6. identify various genetic testing options such as screening, diagnostic and genomic genetic tests	-	-	-	-
PC7. prepare a list of screening, diagnostic and predictive genetic tests required to be performed for a patient/family based on history, clinical findings and course of the disease	-	-	-	-
PC8. evaluate various genetic testing options such as screening, diagnostic and genomic genetic tests as per patient's feasibility	-	-	-	-
<i>Carry out pre-test counselling while interpreting preliminary test results</i>	20	20	10	15
PC9. maintain the confidentiality of medical information regarding patients and families	-	-	-	-
PC10. prepare a plan of action based on preliminary findings	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. educate the patient about various genetic testing options such as screening, diagnostic and genomic genetic tests	-	-	-	-
PC12. apprise the patients and their family members of important aspects of all types of screening and diagnostic genetic testing options such as the availability, analytic and clinical validity etc.	-	-	-	-
PC13. interpret the clinical implications of preliminary genetic test reports	-	-	-	-
PC14. conduct an empirical risk assessment by applying the results of the preliminary tests	-	-	-	-
PC15. apprise the patient of the importance and procedure to carry out predictive genetic testing	-	-	-	-
PC16. interpret the results of pre-symptomatic genetic testing/ carrier testing	-	-	-	-
PC17. guide the patient/ family about various aspects of the test results such as the nature, type, and prognosis of genetic diseases	-	-	-	-
PC18. advise the patient about the differential diagnosis of common presentations in genetic disorders	-	-	-	-
PC19. convey to patient and family, the possibility of likely genetic disorder and plan of required investigations for reaching a diagnosis	-	-	-	-
PC20. address the concerns of the family/patient, allay the doubts based on the available factual information	-	-	-	-
PC21. inform about different types, benefits, and applicable limitations of prenatal and pre-implantation genetic screening tests.	-	-	-	-
PC22. inform about various procedures performed for prenatal sample collection e.g. amniocentesis, chorionic villus biopsy, umbilical cord blood sampling	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC23. inform the patient and the family members about the success rates and failure of each procedure	-	-	-	-
PC24. advise the patient/ family members to share the results of genetic tests with at- risk family members	-	-	-	-
PC25. carry out the process of providing information about the risks of chromosomes abnormalities, birth defects	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	82	60	30	65

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N8714
NOS Name	Assess risk for genetic disorders or syndromes
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Social Work & Community Health
Occupation	Counselling
NSQF Level	6.5
Credits	4
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

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HSS/N8715: Provide counselling on various genetic tests and coordinate for their execution

Description

This unit covers in detail about counseling patients and their family on various diagnostic/ screening test, the facility to conduct them, methods and Turn Around Time (TAT), etc. and coordinating with the physician/ medical geneticist to perform the diagnostic test

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Provide detailed information on various aspects of pre-natal and post-natal screening/diagnostic genetic diseases
- Coordinate with the appropriate specialist/ medical geneticist to carry out identified confirmatory diagnostic genetic test

Elements and Performance Criteria

Provide detailed information on various aspects of pre-natal and post-natal screening/diagnostic genetic diseases

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** prepare contract of agreement to give the results
- PC2.** provide information about all available options of screening/ diagnostic genetic diseases without bias
- PC3.** counsel on the advantages and disadvantages of each option within the context of individual values and beliefs
- PC4.** ensure that patients and family members are given sufficient time and freedom to deliberate and seek further relevant input as necessary
- PC5.** guide the patient about the actionability of the genetic/ genomic test such as likelihood of all possible results such as positive, negative as well as uncertain or unexpected result
- PC6.** notify about the associated financial cost to the patient or family members in an appropriate manner
- PC7.** guide the patient/ family about the screening tests for prenatal screening, newborn screening or any other kind of population screening in detail and comprehensible manner
- PC8.** inform regarding various diagnostic tests for prenatal diagnosis including various sophisticated options like pre-implantation genetic diagnosis
- PC9.** provide appropriate pretest information such as the nature of the sample required, appropriateness, limitations of the test and the scope of the outcome
- PC10.** assist in informed decision making

Coordinate with the appropriate specialist/ medical geneticist to carry out identified confirmatory diagnostic genetic test

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** obtain the pre-test consent

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- PC12.** coordinate with appropriate clinicians and healthcare professionals for consultation time
- PC13.** inform the attending physician/ medical geneticist about the findings of the preliminary examination, pedigree analysis etc.
- PC14.** handover the originals/ copies of the reports of the preliminary findings as and when appropriate to the clinician
- PC15.** address any queries raised by the physician/ geneticist about the patient or collected information
- PC16.** guide the patient/ family members about the next step such as pre- test preparations
- PC17.** co-ordinate with labs/organizations to obtain timely reports

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures in the field of genetics followed in the Healthcare Organization (HCO)/country
- KU2.** service request procedures, tools, and techniques
- KU3.** common apprehensions of the patient and the family and the process to address them
- KU4.** the cultural sensitivity of the patient
- KU5.** the concept and importance of empathy and compassion in treating suffering patients and relatives
- KU6.** the basics of gene mutation
- KU7.** various screening and diagnostic tests and procedures
- KU8.** the verbal and non-verbal cues of the patient and relatives
- KU9.** concept of Variant of Uncertain Significance (VUS)
- KU10.** various genetic diseases or the mutations obtained through Next Generation Sequencing (NGS), or any such genetic test
- KU11.** PNDT Act
- KU12.** ACMG guidelines
- KU13.** newborn screening, diagnostic testing, carrier testing, prenatal testing, preimplantation testing, predictive and presymptomatic testing, forensic testing
- KU14.** types of available genetic tests- diagnostic tests, genetic carrier test, screening tests, predictive tests, pre-symptomatic tests, research tests etc.
- KU15.** importance of single cell multiplex-polymerase chain reactions for monogenic diseases and fluorescent in situ hybridization for chromosomal aberrations
- KU16.** the importance of decision-making in selecting tests or follow-up regarding results
- KU17.** general information about the conditions being tested for, including variability and common features
- KU18.** nature of the testing (screening, carrier screening, diagnostic)
- KU19.** available alternative testing options and the risks, benefits and limitations of each possible results of testing (positive, negative, unclear and unexpected)
- KU20.** Implications and follow-up options if the results are positive
- KU21.** cost of testing and expectations regarding insurance coverage

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- KU22.** various possibility of the test results such as such as a mutation in a different gene
- KU23.** importance and procedure to carry out predictive genetic testing
- KU24.** the options, and limitations of the tests with couples, patients or families with genetic disease
- KU25.** the types of tests that are available like carrier, screening, diagnostic, predictive, pre-symptomatic, and collection of samples for research purposes
- KU26.** process and importance of conveying important information to other team members involved in the care of patients
- KU27.** common genetic test procedures e.g. different types of PCR, DNA extraction, MLPA, real-time PCR, gel electrophoresis, CGH array and sequencing etc
- KU28.** the conditions under which Pre-Natal Diagnosis (PND) is appropriate, and the reasons justifying the same

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** document call logs, reports, task lists, and schedules
- GS2.** write history, clinical findings, status and progress reports
- GS3.** plan for secure record keeping
- GS4.** prepare status and progress reports
- GS5.** write memos and e-mail to patient and the family, co-workers, and vendors to provide them with work updates and to request appropriate information
- GS6.** be updated on the recent advances in the field of genetics in India and other countries by reading relevant published literature, brochures, pamphlets, product information sheets and through participation in professional conferences and seminars
- GS7.** read comments, suggestions, and responses to Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) posted on the helpdesk portal
- GS8.** analyze the patient's reaction to each option and consequence
- GS9.** plan to manage task lists, schedules, and work-loads with co-workers
- GS10.** communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious and gender sensitivity
- GS11.** speak and write in a clear manner and avoid using jargon, slang or acronyms when communicating with a patient, unless it is required
- GS12.** make decisions about the concerned area of work
- GS13.** network adequately with personnel in other departments to coordinate the multi-disciplinary investigations and care of patients with genetic diseases
- GS14.** plan and organize sessions of counseling
- GS15.** maintain ethical behaviour while dealing with the patients and families
- GS16.** network between advocacy groups/support groups and clinicians, researchers
- GS17.** build a therapeutic rapport and manage relationships with patient and the family who may be stressed, frustrated, confused, grieving in denial or angry
- GS18.** think through the problem, evaluate the possible solution(s) and suggest an optimum /best possible solution(s)

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- GS19.** apply, analyze, and evaluate the information gathered from observation, experience, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to thought and action

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Provide detailed information on various aspects of pre-natal and post-natal screening/diagnostic genetic diseases</i>	20	12	10	32
PC1. prepare contract of agreement to give the results	-	-	-	-
PC2. provide information about all available options of screening/ diagnostic genetic diseases without bias	-	-	-	-
PC3. counsel on the advantages and disadvantages of each option within the context of individual values and beliefs	-	-	-	-
PC4. ensure that patients and family members are given sufficient time and freedom to deliberate and seek further relevant input as necessary	-	-	-	-
PC5. guide the patient about the actionability of the genetic/ genomic test such as likelihood of all possible results such as positive, negative as well as uncertain or unexpected result	-	-	-	-
PC6. notify about the associated financial cost to the patient or family members in an appropriate manner	-	-	-	-
PC7. guide the patient/ family about the screening tests for prenatal screening, newborn screening or any other kind of population screening in detail and comprehensible manner	-	-	-	-
PC8. inform regarding various diagnostic tests for prenatal diagnosis including various sophisticated options like pre-implantation genetic diagnosis	-	-	-	-
PC9. provide appropriate pretest information such as the nature of the sample required, appropriateness, limitations of the test and the scope of the outcome	-	-	-	-
PC10. assist in informed decision making	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Coordinate with the appropriate specialist/ medical geneticist to carry out identified confirmatory diagnostic genetic test</i>	25	15	25	32
PC11. obtain the pre-test consent	-	-	-	-
PC12. coordinate with appropriate clinicians and healthcare professionals for consultation time	-	-	-	-
PC13. inform the attending physician/ medical geneticist about the findings of the preliminary examination, pedigree analysis etc.	-	-	-	-
PC14. handover the originals/ copies of the reports of the preliminary findings as and when appropriate to the clinician	-	-	-	-
PC15. address any queries raised by the physician/ geneticist about the patient or collected information	-	-	-	-
PC16. guide the patient/ family members about the next step such as pre- test preparations	-	-	-	-
PC17. co-ordinate with labs/organizations to obtain timely reports	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	45	27	35	64

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N8715
NOS Name	Provide counselling on various genetic tests and coordinate for their execution
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Social Work & Community Health
Occupation	Counselling
NSQF Level	6.5
Credits	3
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

Qualification Pack

HSS/N8716: Interpret the inferences of the genetic tests and carry out post- test counselling

Description

This unit covers the interpretation, documentation and providing information about the result of the genetic tests carried out to the patient and the family members. This unit also include details post- test counselling

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Interpretation and documentation of results of the genetic tests
- Carry out post-test counseling

Elements and Performance Criteria

Interpretation and documentation of results of the genetic tests

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** prepare a plan of action based on the diagnostic findings
- PC2.** make a psychosocial assessment
- PC3.** interpret genetic test reports and their implications on the patient
- PC4.** obtain a second opinion in case of uncertainty
- PC5.** interpret results of various genomic testing as appropriate like chromosomal microarray, whole- exome sequencing, Next Generation Sequencing (NGS) based panel testing, cytogenetic reports (karyotypes, FISH, spectral karyotypes), newborn screening results
- PC6.** file copies of consent forms for assessing medical records, DNA testing or sample storage and copies of correspondence to patient/first and extended families and health professionals
- PC7.** document results of investigations including the records that the reports have been seen by the appropriate health professional
- PC8.** maintain a record of the copies of complete birth records, birth defect register form if applicable and arrangement for follow up
- PC9.** maintain appropriate health record, preferably electronic, in a complete and comprehensive file for each family
- PC10.** access central clinical genetics unit for the records of patients observed in outreach areas
- PC11.** maintain the confidentiality of records
- PC12.** store the files of patients with genetics consultation securely in a separate place at the concerned hospitals/ health records
- PC13.** encourage paperless documentation and record keeping as per the SOPs

Carry out post-test counselling

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC14.** educate the patient and family members about the results of investigations through an agreed process

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- PC15.** communicate the genetic test results timely while maintaining utmost confidentiality
- PC16.** apprise the patient of multidisciplinary clinical examination, electrophysiological/ radiological/ genetic or any other tests required for further diagnosis
- PC17.** schedule communication about further counseling sessions according to the urgency of the timeline in which further testing may be needed
- PC18.** provide psychosocial support
- PC19.** give details about the implications of the genetic tests to the patients and their family members
- PC20.** refer the patient immediately to a medical geneticist to discuss the implications of the findings in detail
- PC21.** assess the emotional status of the patient and family members after disclosure of the test results
- PC22.** provide the written summary of the test result and discussions done during the post counselling session to the patient and family members
- PC23.** provide comprehensive post-test counselling report with definitive health recommendations to the patient and family members
- PC24.** advise the patient and the family members about the follow-up plan
- PC25.** obtain a consent signature on the final post- test report after completion of the case study
- PC26.** document proceedings of a genetic counselling according to the SOPs

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures in the field of genetics followed in the Healthcare Organization (HCO)/country.
- KU2.** the process of ascertaining and complying with current professional credentialing requirements, at the institutional, state, regional and national levels
- KU3.** various notes, records, paperwork required in genetic counselling process
- KU4.** concepts related to interpretation of results like normal finding(s), physiological finding, normal variation, non-specific finding(s) without clinical relevance, incidental finding(s) with possible clinical relevance, finding(s) of uncertain significance, pathognomonic (disease-specific, pathological) finding(s)
- KU5.** importance of informed consent, empathy and confidentiality
- KU6.** the importance of non-directive, non-paternalistic and non-judgmental approach when counseling the patients and relatives
- KU7.** psychosocial impact of the diagnosis
- KU8.** segregation analysis
- KU9.** guidelines, importance and process of documentation and record keeping
- KU10.** the process of forming a network of clinical, diagnostic and research specialists for support to diagnose and manage cases
- KU11.** service request procedures, tools, and techniques
- KU12.** importance of religious and cultural diversity

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- KU13.** process and importance of conveying important information to other team members involved in the care of patients
- KU14.** the method of interpretation of estimate theoretical risks and empirical risks for the disorders
- KU15.** the process of determining the pathogenicity of VUSs using linkage analysis, in silico and functional assays
- KU16.** the complete concept Next Generation Sequencing (NGS) based test
- KU17.** process of distinguishing which Next Generation Sequencing (NGS) obtained data is important and should be considered in the analysis, and which data is not significant
- KU18.** the use of genetic databases in determining variant classification depending on the mutations obtained.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** document call logs, reports, task lists, and schedules
- GS2.** write history, clinical findings, status and progress reports
- GS3.** plan for secure record keeping
- GS4.** write memos and e-mail to patient and the family, co-workers, and stakeholders to provide them with work updates and to request appropriate information
- GS5.** store clinical genetics and the patient database according to the organizational policies
- GS6.** read and correctly interpret internal communications
- GS7.** be updated on the recent advances in the field of genetics in India and other countries by reading relevant published literature, brochures, pamphlets, product information sheets and through participation in professional conferences and seminars
- GS8.**
 - read comments, suggestions, and responses to Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) posted on the helpdesk portal
 - speak and make presentations in English and/or a regional/local language
- GS9.** give clear instructions to the patients/relatives and keep them informed about progress
- GS10.** communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious, gender and PwD sensitivity
- GS11.** speak and write in a clear manner and avoid using jargon, slang or acronyms when communicating with a patient, unless it is required
- GS12.** make decisions about the concerned area of work
- GS13.** interact adequately with personnel in other departments to coordinate the multidisciplinary investigations and care of patients with genetic diseases
- GS14.** use electronic documentation methods and adopt a paperless approach wherever possible
- GS15.** think through the problem, evaluate the possible solution(s) and suggest all available alternatives for patient families to arrive at the best possible solution(s)
- GS16.** prepare and maintain files of clinical genetics units separate from records of the health unit
- GS17.** make decision to ensure security in terms of password access, systems for back-up and virus protection (with regular upgrade)
- GS18.** make plan to use the existing data to arrive at a specific diagnosis
- GS19.** access relevant databases to analyses, interpret and convey the results

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- GS20.** plan and organize sessions of counseling
- GS21.** maintain ethical behaviour while dealing with the patients and families
- GS22.** build a therapeutic rapport and manage relationships with patient and the family who may be stressed, frustrated, confused, grieving in denial or angry
- GS23.** maintain cordial relationships with all other team members
- GS24.** be empathetic with the patient
- GS25.** use the existing data to arrive at specific consequences
- GS26.** apply, analyze, and evaluate the information gathered from observation, experience, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to thought and action

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Interpretation and documentation of results of the genetic tests</i>	30	9	15	25
PC1. prepare a plan of action based on the diagnostic findings	-	-	-	-
PC2. make a psychosocial assessment	-	-	-	-
PC3. interpret genetic test reports and their implications on the patient	-	-	-	-
PC4. obtain a second opinion in case of uncertainty	-	-	-	-
PC5. interpret results of various genomic testing as appropriate like chromosomal microarray, whole-exome sequencing, Next Generation Sequencing (NGS) based panel testing, cytogenetic reports (karyotypes, FISH, spectral karyotypes), newborn screening results	-	-	-	-
PC6. file copies of consent forms for assessing medical records, DNA testing or sample storage and copies of correspondence to patient/first and extended families and health professionals	-	-	-	-
PC7. document results of investigations including the records that the reports have been seen by the appropriate health professional	-	-	-	-
PC8. maintain a record of the copies of complete birth records, birth defect register form if applicable and arrangement for follow up	-	-	-	-
PC9. maintain appropriate health record, preferably electronic, in a complete and comprehensive file for each family	-	-	-	-
PC10. access central clinical genetics unit for the records of patients observed in outreach areas	-	-	-	-
PC11. maintain the confidentiality of records	-	-	-	-
PC12. store the files of patients with genetics consultation securely in a separate place at the concerned hospitals/ health records	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC13. encourage paperless documentation and record keeping as per the SOPs	-	-	-	-
<i>Carry out post-test counseling</i>	20	10	10	20
PC14. educate the patient and family members about the results of investigations through an agreed process	-	-	-	-
PC15. communicate the genetic test results timely while maintaining utmost confidentiality	-	-	-	-
PC16. apprise the patient of multidisciplinary clinical examination, electrophysiological/ radiological/ genetic or any other tests required for further diagnosis	-	-	-	-
PC17. schedule communication about further counseling sessions according to the urgency of the timeline in which further testing may be needed	-	-	-	-
PC18. provide psychosocial support	-	-	-	-
PC19. give details about the implications of the genetic tests to the patients and their family members	-	-	-	-
PC20. refer the patient immediately to a medical geneticist to discuss the implications of the findings in detail	-	-	-	-
PC21. assess the emotional status of the patient and family members after disclosure of the test results	-	-	-	-
PC22. provide the written summary of the test result and discussions done during the post counselling session to the patient and family members	-	-	-	-
PC23. provide comprehensive post-test counselling report with definitive health recommendations to the patient and family members	-	-	-	-
PC24. advise the patient and the family members about the follow-up plan	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC25. obtain a consent signature on the final post-test report after completion of the case study	-	-	-	-
PC26. document proceedings of a genetic counselling according to the SOPs	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	50	19	25	45

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N8716
NOS Name	Interpret the inferences of the genetic tests and carry out post- test counselling
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Social Work & Community Health
Occupation	Counselling
NSQF Level	6.5
Credits	6
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

Qualification Pack

HSS/N8717: Provide need- based genetic counselling to the patient and their family members

Description

This unit covers knowledge and skills required to plan and carry out the genetic counselling session after preparing the patients and their first and extended family members for the same.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Prepare the patient and the paperwork required for counseling
- Provide appropriate genetic counseling to patients and their family members

Elements and Performance Criteria

Prepare the patient and the paperwork required for counseling

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** ensure that the patient appointments are organized
- PC2.** review the purpose of the consultation
- PC3.** guide the patient about the consultation process and possibility of a physical examination
- PC4.** address the concerns that the patient may have regarding the nature and conduct of the consultation
- PC5.** file the plan of the session including cross- references and tests required
- PC6.** ascertain the needs and expectations of the patient/family, identifying any special requirements e.g. wheelchair access or interpreter services and clarify unrealistic expectations of the consultation
- PC7.** provide emotional support to reduce any pre- clinical anxiety
- PC8.** check that all information needed for the consultation has been obtained
- PC9.** review relevant health unit record and/or clinical genetics unit records
- PC10.** prepare information that will be given to the patient, including appropriate support group information and fact sheets as applicable
- PC11.** set the agenda for the counselling session of the patient
- PC12.** ensure that the confidentiality of the patient information is maintained
- PC13.** communicate the concept of adult genetic counselling
- PC14.** consult with the clinical geneticist after a definite diagnosis is drawn to plan prospective counselling sessions

Provide appropriate genetic counseling to patients and their family members

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC15.** prepare detailed pre-test and post-test counselling reports for different genetic conditions having varied inheritance patterns that include monogenic, polygenic, multifactor etiology
- PC16.** provide adequate information about the condition including its prognosis to help patients/families take a decision

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- PC17.** provide full disclosure to individuals and families of all information relevant to their health the nature, usual course, anticipated problems or complications, investigations, management and follow up plan
- PC18.** provide information about the condition, which may include its cause, pattern of inheritance, natural history, complications, and treatment options
- PC19.** provide information about the risk of a condition and their implications affecting the patient, their children and/or other relatives
- PC20.** address the method of providing education on genetic counselling in infertility, developmental and reproductive genetics
- PC21.** communicate the concepts of embryology, dysmorphology and their association with reproductive genetics
- PC22.** address the medical, emotional and social implications for the individual and family
- PC23.** adopt a non-directive approach, except when treatment is available and the affected individuals and families need guidance
- PC24.** communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious, PwD and gender sensitivity and modify the communication pattern as and when necessary
- PC25.** advise about options, including genetic testing and reproductive options and assisting with informed decision making in a non-judgmental / non-coercive manner
- PC26.** arrange genetic tests after obtaining informed consent, which may include carrier testing, predictive testing, screening, research testing
- PC27.** carry out pre-marital counselling
- PC28.** carry out pre-conception counselling
- PC29.** undertake prenatal counselling
- PC30.** provide genetic counseling in specified areas of clinical genetics such as obstetrics, pediatrics, oncology, and neurology
- PC31.** apprise about invasive procedures wherever necessary for future offspring by providing information, education, or reassurance
- PC32.** assess patients' psychological or emotional needs such as those relating to stress, fear of test results, financial issues, and marital conflicts to make referral recommendations or assist patients in managing test outcomes
- PC33.** advise patient and family member to contact close, at risk relatives, for cascade testing
- PC34.** carry out appropriate individualized counselling sessions and refer to a psychologist or other appropriate specialists
- PC35.** document proceedings of a genetic counselling session and hand them over to patient/family for their medical records

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures in the field of genetics followed in the Healthcare Organization (HCO)/country
- KU2.** SOPs of maintaining patient's genetics file
- KU3.** the process of ascertaining and complying with current professional credentialing requirements, at the institutional, state, regional and national levels.

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- KU4.**
 - process of networking with clinical, diagnostic and research specialists for support to diagnose and manage cases
 - service request procedures, tools, and techniques
- KU5.** the religious/ cultural beliefs of the patient
- KU6.** genetic diseases and disorders
- KU7.** process of genetic counselling session
- KU8.** psychosocial aspects of counseling
- KU9.** genetic evaluation for common diseases of adulthood
- KU10.** genomic perspective of genetic counseling
- KU11.** ethics of genetic counseling- basic concepts and relevance to various communities
- KU12.** process of interpretation of test results
- KU13.** components of genetic counseling and case preparation
- KU14.** genotype- phenotype correlation
- KU15.** importance of anticipation
- KU16.** types of counseling to be offered for pre-marital genetics, reproductive genetics, pre-pregnancy genetics, pediatric genetics, oncology genetics, prenatal genetics
- KU17.** penetrance and inheritance of cancer- predisposing gene mutations
- KU18.** risk- reducing and treatment options available for mutation carriers
- KU19.** consanguinity and birth defects
- KU20.** history of pre-marital and pre-conception cases to enquire whether any testing was done for autosomal recessive diseases
- KU21.** the significance of informing the spouses/ partners about the carrier state and possible harmful effects on the marriage from disclosure
- KU22.** risk factors such as aneuploidies of pregnancy at an advanced age
- KU23.** concept, importance and process of amniocentesis
- KU24.** chromosomal microarray analysis
- KU25.** importance of informing blood relatives about the potential genetic risk

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** document call logs, reports, task lists, and schedules
- GS2.** write history, clinical findings, status and progress reports
- GS3.** plan for secure record keeping
- GS4.** write proceedings of a genetic counselling session in an appropriate manner
- GS5.** be updated on the recent advances in the field of genetics in India and other countries by reading relevant published literature, brochures, pamphlets, product information sheets and through participation in professional conferences and seminars
- GS6.**
 - read comments, suggestions, and responses to Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) posted on the helpdesk portal
 - communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious, gender and PwD sensitivity
- GS7.** communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious, gender and PwD sensitivity

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- GS8.** plan to identify social and/or cultural issues which may impinge on the consultation
- GS9.** speak and write in a clear manner and avoid using jargon, slang or acronyms when communicating with a patient, unless it is required
- GS10.** make decisions of the concerned area of work
- GS11.** work in close contact with clinical geneticist and scientist to provide efficient genetic counseling services
- GS12.**
 - respect the rights of persons and families to full disclosure of their conditions after the diagnosis
 - preserve family integrity
- GS13.** preserve family integrity
- GS14.** plan to involve children and adolescents in the decisions affecting them
- GS15.** make decisions to protect the privacy of individuals and families from unjustified intrusion by authorities, employers, and insurers
- GS16.** interact adequately with personnel in other departments to coordinate the multidisciplinary investigations and care of patients with genetic diseases
- GS17.** plan and organize sessions of counseling
- GS18.** maintain ethical behaviour while dealing with the patients and families
- GS19.**
 - be cautious of using outdated, offensive terms while communicating with the patient/ family members
 - network between advocacy groups/support groups and clinicians, researchers
- GS20.** network between advocacy groups/support groups and clinicians, researchers
- GS21.** make use of assistive technology when necessary while during counselling session with PwD
- GS22.** manage relationships with clients who may be stressed, frustrated, confused, or angry by using patient-centric approach
- GS23.** think through the problem, evaluate the possible solution(s) and suggest an optimum /best possible solution(s)
- GS24.** apply, analyze, and evaluate the information gathered from observation, experience, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to thought and action

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Prepare the patient and the paperwork required for counseling</i>	20	15	10	20
PC1. ensure that the patient appointments are organized	-	-	-	-
PC2. review the purpose of the consultation	-	-	-	-
PC3. guide the patient about the consultation process and possibility of a physical examination	-	-	-	-
PC4. address the concerns that the patient may have regarding the nature and conduct of the consultation	-	-	-	-
PC5. file the plan of the session including cross-references and tests required	-	-	-	-
PC6. ascertain the needs and expectations of the patient/family, identifying any special requirements e.g. wheelchair access or interpreter services and clarify unrealistic expectations of the consultation	-	-	-	-
PC7. provide emotional support to reduce any pre-clinical anxiety	-	-	-	-
PC8. check that all information needed for the consultation has been obtained	-	-	-	-
PC9. review relevant health unit record and/or clinical genetics unit records	-	-	-	-
PC10. prepare information that will be given to the patient, including appropriate support group information and fact sheets as applicable	-	-	-	-
PC11. set the agenda for the counselling session of the patient	-	-	-	-
PC12. ensure that the confidentiality of the patient information is maintained	-	-	-	-
PC13. communicate the concept of adult genetic counselling	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC14. consult with the clinical geneticist after a definite diagnosis is drawn to plan prospective counselling sessions	-	-	-	-
<i>Provide appropriate genetic counseling to patients and their family members</i>	17	15	15	15
PC15. prepare detailed pre-test and post-test counselling reports for different genetic conditions having varied inheritance patterns that include monogenic, polygenic, multifactor etiology	-	-	-	-
PC16. provide adequate information about the condition including its prognosis to help patients/families take a decision	-	-	-	-
PC17. provide full disclosure to individuals and families of all information relevant to their health the nature, usual course, anticipated problems or complications, investigations, management and follow up plan	-	-	-	-
PC18. provide information about the condition, which may include its cause, pattern of inheritance, natural history, complications, and treatment options	-	-	-	-
PC19. provide information about the risk of a condition and their implications affecting the patient, their children and/or other relatives	-	-	-	-
PC20. address the method of providing education on genetic counselling in infertility, developmental and reproductive genetics	-	-	-	-
PC21. communicate the concepts of embryology, dysmorphology and their association with reproductive genetics	-	-	-	-
PC22. address the medical, emotional and social implications for the individual and family	-	-	-	-
PC23. adopt a non-directive approach, except when treatment is available and the affected individuals and families need guidance	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC24. communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious, PwD and gender sensitivity and modify the communication pattern as and when necessary	-	-	-	-
PC25. advise about options, including genetic testing and reproductive options and assisting with informed decision making in a non-judgmental / non-coercive manner	-	-	-	-
PC26. arrange genetic tests after obtaining informed consent, which may include carrier testing, predictive testing, screening, research testing	-	-	-	-
PC27. carry out pre-marital counselling	-	-	-	-
PC28. carry out pre-conception counselling	-	-	-	-
PC29. undertake prenatal counselling	-	-	-	-
PC30. provide genetic counseling in specified areas of clinical genetics such as obstetrics, pediatrics, oncology, and neurology	-	-	-	-
PC31. apprise about invasive procedures wherever necessary for future offspring by providing information, education, or reassurance	-	-	-	-
PC32. assess patients' psychological or emotional needs such as those relating to stress, fear of test results, financial issues, and marital conflicts to make referral recommendations or assist patients in managing test outcomes	-	-	-	-
PC33. advise patient and family member to contact close, at risk relatives, for cascade testing	-	-	-	-
PC34. carry out appropriate individualized counselling sessions and refer to a psychologist or other appropriate specialists	-	-	-	-
PC35. document proceedings of a genetic counselling session and hand them over to patient/family for their medical records	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	37	30	25	35

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N8717
NOS Name	Provide need- based genetic counselling to the patient and their family members
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Social Work & Community Health
Occupation	Counselling
NSQF Level	6.5
Credits	17
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

Qualification Pack

HSS/N8718: Promote genetics related awareness

Description

This unit covers details about creating awareness related to genetic counseling. It discusses in detail about how to promote activities related to genetic counseling amongst the fellow non-genetics healthcare providers and promote the advocacy the objective of the genetic counselling profession.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Educate the fellow healthcare providers about the merits of genetic counseling
- Identify and educate the at-risk population regarding the need for genetic counseling

Elements and Performance Criteria

Educate the fellow healthcare providers about the merits of genetic counseling

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** update and maintain literature related to genetics for its usage in continuous learning programs and conferences
- PC2.** design genetics training programs for physicians, graduate students and other health professionals by doing a gaps analysis
- PC3.** conduct sensitization and refresher genetics training programs for physicians, graduate students and other health professionals.
- PC4.** support healthcare team in research activities related to the field in the healthcare facility
- PC5.** evaluate or make recommendations for drafting standards in genetics as appropriate
- PC6.** liaison between genetics-trained and non-genetics-trained health care providers for educating and supporting them in the genetics domain
- PC7.** prepare and provide genetics-related educational materials to patients or medical personnel
- PC8.** ensure IEC material used are paperless by substituting handouts/ pamphlets/ leaflets with electronic presentation
- PC9.** ensure compliance and adherence with the ethical/ legal issues surrounding the access and use of information, media, information technology

Identify and educate the at-risk population regarding the need for genetic counseling

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** identify community resources/NGOs involved in education, support services, physiotherapy, speech therapy or offering any other aids to individuals with special needs
- PC11.** connect with major genetics and local administration to utilize them advocates for genetic counselling education sessions in the community
- PC12.** prepare appropriate Information, Education and Communication (IEC) material and encourage re-use of material
- PC13.** address patient's attitudes, perceptions and concern areas such as, privacy concerns, values, social norms, lack of perceived benefit and fatalism, etc.

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- PC14.** educate the community on subjects like preventative counseling, associated myths and screening etc
- PC15.** plan and organize community programs on genetic counselling including group counselling sessions
- PC16.** provide genetics services such as prenatal screening to minority and underserved communities while maintaining the confidentiality of medical information
- PC17.** educate the families about the community resources/ societies/ voluntary organization for specific genetic disorders for patient registration or support

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** the importance of being a part of a multi-disciplinary team
- KU2.** the importance of working in close contact with clinical geneticist and scientists to provide efficient genetic counselling services
- KU3.** relevant legislation, standards, policies, and procedures in the field of genetics followed in the Healthcare Organization (HCO)/country
- KU4.** process of engaging with both internal and external specialists for support to resolve incidents and service requests
- KU5.** the concept of population genetics
- KU6.** importance of social media in awareness activities
- KU7.** effective use of charts/leaflets and other IEC material for counseling preferably electronic presentation
- KU8.**
 - strategy of connecting organizations/advocacy groups working in their region/country for providing community, social, legal and economic support to individuals and families suffering from genetic disorders
 - existing socio-cultural contexts
- KU9.** existing socio-cultural contexts
- KU10.** the method of preparation of charts/leaflets/presentations for advocacy of genetic counseling profession to healthcare providers
- KU11.** the benefits of association or registration with organization catering to genetic disorders
- KU12.** protocols for conducting surveys
- KU13.** the process of delivering information using visual aids, slides, electronic presentation, hand-outs , and engage with media
- KU14.** importance of outreach programs to spread awareness about basics of genetics and dispel myths, among the community
- KU15.** various religious/ cultural perspectives in the field of genetics
- KU16.** appropriate IEC material to educate community with various language backgrounds
- KU17.** the effective methodology of conserving and re-using IEC material
- KU18.** the importance of optimizing material utilization used for awareness related activities
- KU19.** various materials which can be replaced by environment friendly substitutes
- KU20.** importance and process of organizing Continuing Medical Education (CMEs) and Continuing Nursing Education (CNEs) for hospital staff

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KU21. the process of tackling any negative publicity pertaining to organ donation that might arise

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** document call logs, reports, task lists, and schedules
- GS2.** write history, clinical findings, status, and progress reports
- GS3.** plan for secure record keeping
- GS4.** write a to-the-point and crisp message for counseling in the community
- GS5.** write memos and e-mail to patient and the family, co-workers, and vendors to provide them with work updates and to request appropriate information
- GS6.** write grant proposals for eligible programs or services as and when necessary
- GS7.** be updated on the recent advances in the field of genetics in India and other countries by reading brochures, pamphlets, product information sheets and through participation in professional conferences and seminars
- GS8.** respect the cultural, religious, gender diversity of the patient
- GS9.** treat suffering patients and relatives with empathy and compassion
- GS10.** read and correctly interpret internal communications
- GS11.** address comments, suggestions, and responses to Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) posted on the helpdesk portal
- GS12.** speak and make presentations in English and a regional/local language
- GS13.** network with co-workers to discuss task lists, schedules, and work-loads
- GS14.** be encouraged to extend and expand counselling for common disorders
- GS15.** work as a team with clinical geneticist and scientist to provide efficient genetic counseling services in the community
- GS16.** communicate in a way that reflects cultural, religious, gender and PwD sensitivity
- GS17.** speak and write in a clear manner and avoid using jargon, slang or acronyms when communicating with a patient, unless it is required
- GS18.** make decisions about the concerned area of work
- GS19.** network adequately with personnel in other departments to coordinate the multi-disciplinary investigations and care of patients with genetic diseases
- GS20.** network between advocacy groups/support groups and clinicians, researchers
- GS21.** plan and organize sessions of counseling
- GS22.** maintain ethical behaviour while dealing with the patients and families
- GS23.** build a therapeutic rapport and manage relationships with patient and the family who may be stressed, frustrated, confused, grieving in denial or angry
- GS24.** maintain cordial relationships with all other team members
- GS25.** think through the problem, evaluate the possible solution(s) and suggest an optimum /best possible solution(s)
- GS26.** apply, analyze, and evaluate the information gathered from observation, experience, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to thought and action

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Educate the fellow healthcare providers about the merits of genetic counseling</i>	25	-	-	20
PC1. update and maintain literature related to genetics for its usage in continuous learning programs and conferences	-	-	-	-
PC2. design genetics training programs for physicians, graduate students and other health professionals by doing a gaps analysis	-	-	-	-
PC3. conduct sensitization and refresher genetics training programs for physicians, graduate students and other health professionals.	-	-	-	-
PC4. support healthcare team in research activities related to the field in the healthcare facility	-	-	-	-
PC5. evaluate or make recommendations for drafting standards in genetics as appropriate	-	-	-	-
PC6. liaison between genetics-trained and non-genetics-trained health care providers for educating and supporting them in the genetics domain	-	-	-	-
PC7. prepare and provide genetics-related educational materials to patients or medical personnel	-	-	-	-
PC8. ensure IEC material used are paperless by substituting handouts/ pamphlets/ leaflets with electronic presentation	-	-	-	-
PC9. ensure compliance and adherence with the ethical/ legal issues surrounding the access and use of information, media, information technology	-	-	-	-
<i>Identify and educate the at-risk population regarding the need for genetic counseling</i>	24	-	10	15
PC10. identify community resources/NGOs involved in education, support services, physiotherapy, speech therapy or offering any other aids to individuals with special needs	-	-	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. connect with major genetics and local administration to utilize them advocates for genetic counselling education sessions in the community	-	-	-	-
PC12. prepare appropriate Information, Education and Communication (IEC) material and encourage re-use of material	-	-	-	-
PC13. address patient's attitudes, perceptions and concern areas such as, privacy concerns, values, social norms, lack of perceived benefit and fatalism, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC14. educate the community on subjects like preventative counseling, associated myths and screening etc	-	-	-	-
PC15. plan and organize community programs on genetic counselling including group counselling sessions	-	-	-	-
PC16. provide genetics services such as prenatal screening to minority and underserved communities while maintaining the confidentiality of medical information	-	-	-	-
PC17. educate the families about the community resources/ societies/ voluntary organization for specific genetic disorders for patient registration or support	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	49	-	10	35

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N8718
NOS Name	Promote genetics related awareness
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Social Work & Community Health
Occupation	Counselling
NSQF Level	6.5
Credits	6
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

Qualification Pack

HSS/N9620: Comply with infection control and biomedical waste disposal policies

Description

This OS unit is about the safe handling and management of health care waste and following infection control policies

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Management of Healthcare Waste (Biomedical and General waste)
- Infection control practices

Elements and Performance Criteria

Management of Healthcare Waste (Biomedical and General waste)

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC1. segregate healthcare waste as per the updated organizational/ state policies

PC2. handle, package, label, store, transport and dispose off waste appropriately as per scope of work

Infection control practices

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC3. follow Universal Precautions to avoid contact with patients' bodily fluids, by wearing Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) and maintaining hand hygiene as and when required

PC4. identify infection risks and plan for response appropriately as per organizational policies under scope of work

PC5. follow incident reporting protocols as per SOPs in incidents such as needle stick injuries etc.

PC6. follow spill management protocols

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. significance of appropriate waste disposal methods as per organizational policies and procedures

KU2. person(s) responsible for health, safety, and security in the organization

KU3. ways to handle waste appropriately to reduce the risk of contamination

KU4. good personal hygiene practices including hand hygiene

KU5. types of bio medical waste

KU6. different types of color codes designated for types of wastes

KU7. concept of segregation, disposal and treatment of bio medical waste

KU8. the hazards and risks associated with the waste disposal

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- KU9.** the required actions and reporting procedures for any accidents and spillages
- KU10.** the requirements of the relevant external agencies involved in the transportation and receiving of waste
- KU11.** the impact of waste on environmental changes
- KU12.** the policies and guidance that clarify scope of practice, accountabilities and the working relationship between oneself and others
- KU13.** management of infection risks at workplace
- KU14.** the path of disease transmission including direct contact and penetrating injuries, risk of acquisition
- KU15.** difference between clean, sterile, and unsterile area
- KU16.** concept of Universal precautions
- KU17.** types of PPE used in healthcare domain such as gloves, gown, goggles etc
- KU18.** correct method of Donning and Doffing of PPE
- KU19.** steps of hand washing according to the updated guidelines
- KU20.** difference between hand rub and hand washing and indications of both
- KU21.** various types of cleaning agents and disinfectants
- KU22.** types of hazardous spills
- KU23.** concept of injection safety
- KU24.** concept of respiratory hygiene

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** • read and understand latest guidelines on managing biomedical waste and
• infection control and prevention
- GS2.** communicate effectively with others
- GS3.** report hazards and incidents clearly with the appropriate level of urgency
- GS4.** plan for safety of the work environment
- GS5.** identify risk, evaluate possible solutions and suggest effective solutions
- GS6.** analyse the seriousness of hazards pertaining to hospital waste and related infections
- GS7.** make decisions pertaining to the area of work
- GS8.** • apply, analyze, and evaluate the information gathered from observation, experience,
• reasoning, or communication, as a guide to act

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Management of Healthcare Waste (Biomedical and General waste)</i>	9	7	2	8
PC1. segregate healthcare waste as per the updated organizational/ state policies	-	-	-	-
PC2. handle, package, label, store, transport and dispose off waste appropriately as per scope of work	-	-	-	-
<i>Infection control practices</i>	12	7	3	8
PC3. follow Universal Precautions to avoid contact with patients' bodily fluids, by wearing Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) and maintaining hand hygiene as and when required	-	-	-	-
PC4. identify infection risks and plan for response appropriately as per organizational policies under scope of work	-	-	-	-
PC5. follow incident reporting protocols as per SOPs in incidents such as needle stick injuries etc.	-	-	-	-
PC6. follow spill management protocols	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	21	14	5	16

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N9620
NOS Name	Comply with infection control and biomedical waste disposal policies
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Allied Health & Paramedics
Occupation	Generic
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	2.0
Last Reviewed Date	12/03/2026
Next Review Date	12/03/2029
NSQC Clearance Date	12/03/2026

Qualification Pack

DGT/VSQ/N0103: Employability Skills (90 Hours)

Description

This unit is about employability skills, Constitutional values, becoming a professional in the 21st Century, digital, financial, and legal literacy, diversity and Inclusion, English and communication skills, customer service, entrepreneurship, and apprenticeship, getting ready for jobs and career development.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Introduction to Employability Skills
- Constitutional values - Citizenship
- Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century
- Basic English Skills
- Career Development & Goal Setting
- Communication Skills
- Diversity & Inclusion
- Financial and Legal Literacy
- Essential Digital Skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Customer Service
- Getting ready for Apprenticeship & Jobs

Elements and Performance Criteria

Introduction to Employability Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** understand the significance of employability skills in meeting the current job market requirement and future of work
- PC2.** identify and explore learning and employability relevant portals
- PC3.** research about the different industries, job market trends, latest skills required and the available opportunities

Constitutional values – Citizenship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC4.** recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.
- PC5.** follow environmentally sustainable practices

Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment

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- PC7.** practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life
- PC8.** adopt a continuous learning mindset for personal and professional development

Basic English Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC9.** use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone
- PC10.** read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English
- PC11.** write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English

Career Development & Goal Setting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC12.** identify career goals based on the skills, interests, knowledge, and personal attributes
- PC13.** prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals

Communication Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC14.** follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette while communicating in professional and public settings
- PC15.** use active listening techniques for effective communication
- PC16.** communicate in writing using appropriate style and format based on formal or informal requirements
- PC17.** work collaboratively with others in a team

Diversity & Inclusion

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC18.** communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD
- PC19.** escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act

Financial and Legal Literacy

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC20.** identify and select reliable institutions for various financial products and services such as bank account, debit and credit cards, loans, insurance etc.
- PC21.** carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely, using various methods and check the entries in the passbook
- PC22.** identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc
- PC23.** identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation

Essential Digital Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC24.** operate digital devices and use their features and applications securely and safely
- PC25.** carry out basic internet operations by connecting to the internet safely and securely, using the mobile data or other available networks through Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, etc.
- PC26.** display responsible online behaviour while using various social media platforms

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- PC27.** create a personal email account, send and process received messages as per requirement
- PC28.** carry out basic procedures in documents, spreadsheets and presentations using respective and appropriate applications
- PC29.** utilize virtual collaboration tools to work effectively

Entrepreneurship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC30.** identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research
- PC31.** develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion
- PC32.** identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity

Customer Service

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC33.** identify different types of customers and ways to communicate with them
- PC34.** identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner
- PC35.** use appropriate tools to collect customer feedback
- PC36.** follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards

Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC37.** create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)
- PC38.** search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively
- PC39.** apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement
- PC40.** answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection
- PC41.** identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** need for employability skills and different learning and employability related portals
- KU2.** various constitutional and personal values
- KU3.** different environmentally sustainable practices and their importance
- KU4.** Twenty first (21st) century skills and their importance
- KU5.** how to use English language for effective verbal (face to face and telephonic) and written communication in formal and informal set up
- KU6.** importance of career development and setting long- and short-term goals
- KU7.** about effective communication
- KU8.** POSH Act
- KU9.** Gender sensitivity and inclusivity
- KU10.** different types of financial institutes, products, and services

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- KU11.** components of salary and how to compute income and expenditure
- KU12.** importance of maintaining safety and security in offline and online financial transactions
- KU13.** different legal rights and laws
- KU14.** different types of digital devices and the procedure to operate them safely and securely
- KU15.** how to create and operate an e- mail account
- KU16.** use applications such as word processors, spreadsheets etc.
- KU17.** how to identify business opportunities
- KU18.** types and needs of customers
- KU19.** how to apply for a job and prepare for an interview
- KU20.** apprenticeship scheme and the process of registering on apprenticeship portal

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** read and write different types of documents/instructions/correspondence in English and other languages
- GS2.** communicate effectively using appropriate language in formal and informal settings
- GS3.** behave politely and appropriately with all to maintain effective work relationship
- GS4.** how to work in a virtual mode, using various technological platforms
- GS5.** perform calculations efficiently
- GS6.** solve problems effectively
- GS7.** pay attention to details
- GS8.** manage time efficiently
- GS9.** maintain hygiene and sanitization to avoid infection

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Introduction to Employability Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC1. understand the significance of employability skills in meeting the current job market requirement and future of work	-	-	-	-
PC2. identify and explore learning and employability relevant portals	-	-	-	-
PC3. research about the different industries, job market trends, latest skills required and the available opportunities	-	-	-	-
<i>Constitutional values – Citizenship</i>	1	1	-	-
PC4. recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC5. follow environmentally sustainable practices	-	-	-	-
<i>Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century</i>	1	3	-	-
PC6. recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment	-	-	-	-
PC7. practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life	-	-	-	-
PC8. adopt a continuous learning mindset for personal and professional development	-	-	-	-
<i>Basic English Skills</i>	3	4	-	-
PC9. use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English	-	-	-	-
PC11. write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English	-	-	-	-
<i>Career Development & Goal Setting</i>	1	2	-	-
PC12. identify career goals based on the skills, interests, knowledge, and personal attributes	-	-	-	-
PC13. prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals	-	-	-	-
<i>Communication Skills</i>	2	2	-	-
PC14. follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette while communicating in professional and public settings	-	-	-	-
PC15. use active listening techniques for effective communication	-	-	-	-
PC16. communicate in writing using appropriate style and format based on formal or informal requirements	-	-	-	-
PC17. work collaboratively with others in a team	-	-	-	-
<i>Diversity & Inclusion</i>	1	1	-	-
PC18. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD	-	-	-	-
PC19. escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act	-	-	-	-
<i>Financial and Legal Literacy</i>	2	3	-	-
PC20. identify and select reliable institutions for various financial products and services such as bank account, debit and credit cards, loans, insurance etc.	-	-	-	-
PC21. carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely, using various methods and check the entries in the passbook	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC22. identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc	-	-	-	-
PC23. identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation	-	-	-	-
<i>Essential Digital Skills</i>	3	5	-	-
PC24. operate digital devices and use their features and applications securely and safely	-	-	-	-
PC25. carry out basic internet operations by connecting to the internet safely and securely, using the mobile data or other available networks through Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC26. display responsible online behaviour while using various social media platforms	-	-	-	-
PC27. create a personal email account, send and process received messages as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC28. carry out basic procedures in documents, spreadsheets and presentations using respective and appropriate applications	-	-	-	-
PC29. utilize virtual collaboration tools to work effectively	-	-	-	-
<i>Entrepreneurship</i>	2	3	-	-
PC30. identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research	-	-	-	-
PC31. develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion	-	-	-	-
PC32. identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity	-	-	-	-
<i>Customer Service</i>	1	2	-	-
PC33. identify different types of customers and ways to communicate with them	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC34. identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner	-	-	-	-
PC35. use appropriate tools to collect customer feedback	-	-	-	-
PC36. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards	-	-	-	-
<i>Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs</i>	2	3	-	-
PC37. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)	-	-	-	-
PC38. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively	-	-	-	-
PC39. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC40. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection	-	-	-	-
PC41. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	DGT/VSQ/N0103
NOS Name	Employability Skills (90 Hours)
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	Professional Skills
Occupation	Employability
NSQF Level	5
Credits	3
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	07/10/2025
Next Review Date	07/10/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	07/10/2025

Assessment Guidelines and Assessment Weightage

Assessment Guidelines

1. Criteria for assessment for each Qualification Pack will be created by the Sector Skill Council. Each Performance Criteria (PC) will be assigned marks proportional to its importance in NOS. SSC will also lay down the proportion of marks for Theory and Skills Practical for each PC.
2. The assessment for the theory part will be based on the knowledge bank of questions created by the SSC.
3. Assessment will be conducted for all compulsory NOS, and where applicable, on the selected elective/option NOS/set of NOS.
4. Individual assessment agencies will create unique question papers for the theory part for each candidate at each examination/training center (as per assessment criteria below).
5. Individual assessment agencies will create unique evaluations for skill practical for every student at each examination/ training center based on these criteria.
6. To pass the Qualification Pack assessment, every trainee should score a minimum of 70% of % aggregate marks to successfully clear the assessment.

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7. In case of unsuccessful completion, the trainee may seek reassessment on the Qualification Pack.

Minimum Aggregate Passing % at QP Level : 70

(Please note: Every Trainee should score a minimum aggregate passing percentage as specified above, to successfully clear the Qualification Pack assessment.)

Assessment Weightage

Compulsory NOS

National Occupational Standards	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks	Total Marks	Weightage
HSS/N8713.Collect detailed patient and family history to draw a pedigree	46	20	20	40	126	10
HSS/N8714.Assess risk for genetic disorders or syndromes	82	60	30	65	237	20
HSS/N8715.Provide counselling on various genetic tests and coordinate for their execution	45	27	35	64	171	20
HSS/N8716.Interpret the inferences of the genetic tests and carry out post- test counselling	50	19	25	45	139	15
HSS/N8717.Provide need- based genetic counselling to the patient and their family members	37	30	25	35	127	10
HSS/N8718.Promote genetics related awareness	49	-	10	35	94	10
HSS/N9620.Comply with infection control and biomedical waste disposal policies	21	14	5	16	56	5
DGT/VSQ/N0103.Employability Skills (90 Hours)	20	30	-	-	50	10
Total	350	200	150	300	1000	100

Qualification Pack

Acronyms

NOS	National Occupational Standard(s)
NSQF	National Skills Qualifications Framework
QP	Qualifications Pack
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

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Glossary

Sector	Sector is a conglomeration of different business operations having similar business and interests. It may also be defined as a distinct subset of the economy whose components share similar characteristics and interests.
Sub-sector	Sub-sector is derived from a further breakdown based on the characteristics and interests of its components.
Occupation	Occupation is a set of job roles, which perform similar/ related set of functions in an industry.
Job role	Job role defines a unique set of functions that together form a unique employment opportunity in an organisation.
Occupational Standards (OS)	OS specify the standards of performance an individual must achieve when carrying out a function in the workplace, together with the Knowledge and Understanding (KU) they need to meet that standard consistently. Occupational Standards are applicable both in the Indian and global contexts.
Performance Criteria (PC)	Performance Criteria (PC) are statements that together specify the standard of performance required when carrying out a task.
National Occupational Standards (NOS)	NOS are occupational standards which apply uniquely in the Indian context.
Qualifications Pack (QP)	QP comprises the set of OS, together with the educational, training and other criteria required to perform a job role. A QP is assigned a unique qualifications pack code.
Unit Code	Unit code is a unique identifier for an Occupational Standard, which is denoted by an 'N'
Unit Title	Unit title gives a clear overall statement about what the incumbent should be able to do.
Description	Description gives a short summary of the unit content. This would be helpful to anyone searching on a database to verify that this is the appropriate OS they are looking for.
Scope	Scope is a set of statements specifying the range of variables that an individual may have to deal with in carrying out the function which have a critical impact on quality of performance required.

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)	Knowledge and Understanding (KU) are statements which together specify the technical, generic, professional and organisational specific knowledge that an individual needs in order to perform to the required standard.
Organisational Context	Organisational context includes the way the organisation is structured and how it operates, including the extent of operative knowledge managers have of their relevant areas of responsibility.
Technical Knowledge	Technical knowledge is the specific knowledge needed to accomplish specific designated responsibilities.
Core Skills/ Generic Skills (GS)	Core skills or Generic Skills (GS) are a group of skills that are the key to learning and working in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment. In the context of the OS, these include communication related skills that are applicable to most job roles.
Electives	Electives are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as contributive to specialization in a job role. There may be multiple electives within a QP for each specialized job role. Trainees must select at least one elective for the successful completion of a QP with Electives.
Options	Options are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as additional skills. There may be multiple options within a QP. It is not mandatory to select any of the options to complete a QP with Options.